

3.6 Troubleshooting: Unsticking a Frozen Layer

If you freeze on a specific layer and cannot produce even a best guess, use this prompt. Paste it into your AI tool along with whatever partial data you have, and let the AI offer three possibilities. Choose the one that resonates, adjust it, and keep moving.

Copy the prompt below into your AI tool. Fill in every bracket before generating.

I am building a psychological voice profile for a character in a [GENRE] novel. I am stuck on [LAYER_NAME, e.g., "Layer Five: Core Wounds"]. Here is what I know about this character so far:

[PASTE_WHATEVER_PARTIAL_DATA_YOU_HAVE — name, backstory, personality notes, even vague impressions]

Based on this information, suggest three possible [LAYER_FOCUS, e.g., "core wound beliefs that would produce clipped, reluctant speech patterns"]. For each suggestion, explain how it would manifest in the character's dialogue.

Selection rule: Pay attention to the suggestion that makes your chest tighten. That physical response is your signal to choose it. Write that suggestion down, and then continue to the next layer.